different areas involved in the Doha Round negotiations. *Pascal Lamy*, Director General of the WTO, said in a statement March 29, 2011, that the *'biggest stumbling block' was what is called 'NAMA sectorals'*. This is about proposals for major trading countries, including emerging economies, to allow duty-free or lower-than-normal duty on imports in particular sectors within the non-agricultural market access (NAMA), negotiations.

That assessment was also made very clear in the statement by the US Trade Representative at the MC8, '*… the current impasse in many ways comes down to one single, vexing quandary: the WTO has not come to terms over core questions of shared responsibilities among its biggest and most successful Members. The world has changed profoundly since the negotiations began a decade ago, most obviously in the rise of the emerging economies. The results of our negotiations thus far do not reflect this change, and yet they must if we are to be successful.'*

TRIPS issues had already earlier in 2011 been placed in what was called a 'slow lane' in the negotiations. For the 'Easter package' in April 2011, the status of the **GI** (Geographic Indication) issues and of the TRIPS/CBD issue was reported by the Director-General, document TN/C/W/61 dated April 21, 2011. On the TRIPS/CBD issue a submission was made in the context of the Easter Package from a number of WTO Members including *Brazil*, *India*, and *China* in April 2011, requesting a revised version of the TRIPS Agreement calling for *disclosure of origin of genetic resources* and/or associated *Traditional Knowledge* involved in patent applications. Noteworthy in that this submission was not sponsored by the EU and Switzerland, two of the original sponsors of the 2008 'mini-ministerial' proposal for a TRIPS package on GIs and disclosure of origin of genetic resources. Nevertheless, of the decisions taken at the MC8, two are TRIPS-related:

(i) extending until the next Ministerial Conference, to be held in 2013, the moratorium on what is called "non-violation omplaints" under the TRIPS Agreement; and

(ii) instructing the TRIPS Council to extend, under TRIPS Article 66.1, the transition period expiring June 30, 2013, for LDCs, for implementing the TRIPS Agreement.